

Grade 1 Ontario Curriculum Numbers

Number Friends to 50

Unit Overview: Number Friends to 50

Grade: Grade 1 | **Strand:** Numbers

Target Expectations: B1.1, B1.2, B1.3, B1.4, B1.5, B1.6, B1.7, B1.8

Learning Goal: Children will read, represent, compose, decompose, compare, order, estimate, and count whole numbers to 50, share collections fairly between 2 and 4 sharers, and recognise that one half equals two fourths of the same whole.

Lesson	Lesson Title	Learning Goal
Day 1	Count Big with Lila	I can estimate how many in a collection up to 50, and count by 1s, 2s, 5s, and 10s to check.
Day 2	Read and Show Numbers	I can read and represent numbers to 50 in many ways and tell where I see numbers in everyday life.
Day 3	Make and Break 50	I can compose and decompose any number to 50 using tens, ones, and partner pairs in different ways.
Day 4	Compare and Order	I can compare two numbers up to 50 and order a small set from smallest to biggest.
Day 5	Fair Shares — Halves and Fourths	I can share a small collection fairly between 2 or 4 friends, draw the share, and tell that one half equals two fourths.

Lesson 1: Count Big with Lila

Goal: Bigger collections need smarter counting. We can count by 1s, 2s, 5s, or 10s.

Expectation: B1.4, B1.5

Learning Goal: "I can estimate how many in a collection up to 50, and count by 1s, 2s, 5s, and 10s to check."

Materials: M1_button_set, M2_estimation_jar, M4_number_line_floor

1. Minds On (12 mins): Lila's Mystery Button Jar

Lila's button jar is BIGGER than last year's. Can your eyes still figure out how many? Scoot zooms in with Lila to open: 'Big numbers? Big counting!' Class echoes.

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Lila and a clear glass jar holding ~38 buttons.

2. Action (25 mins): Skip-Count Stations

- Whole group: walk the Number Line floor mat together by 1s from 0 to 20.
- Stretch: count by 5s starting from 17 (NOT a multiple of 5).
- Send pairs to three stations.
- Circulate to record formative evidence on the diagnostic tracker.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Lila's Counting Brag

Discuss:

- What's the smartest way to count buttons in a big collection?
- When is counting by 10s faster than counting by 1s?
- Why might Lila's chunk-strategy estimate sometimes be off by 5 or 10?
- If you had a jar of 50 buttons, how would you count them?

Exit: Each child whispers to a partner: 'I would count my 50 buttons by ___s, because ____.' Partners share a few examples with the class.

Lesson 2: Read and Show Numbers

Goal: The same number can be shown many ways: numerals, words, ten-frames, base-ten rods, tally marks.

Expectation: B1.1

Learning Goal: "I can read and represent numbers to 50 in many ways and tell where I see numbers in everyday life."

Materials: M3_base_ten_rods, M7_number_word_cards

1. Minds On (10 mins): The Same Number, Five Ways

Otto found the number 32 written in five different places yesterday. Can you spot how they all mean the same thing? Scoot scampers to the chart: 'Numbers tell stories — show me yours!'

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Otto and a sample gallery card showing the number 32 in five forms.

2. Action (25 mins): Number Friends Gallery Walk

- Set up 5 gallery stations around the classroom.
- Mid-rotation pause: bring children back to the carpet.
- Send pairs back to finish the rotations.
- Real-life Number Hunt.
- Closing chart-build.

3. Consolidation (10 mins): Same Number, Different Place

Discuss:

- Which form was easiest to read for you?
- Why might a teacher use base-ten rods instead of just writing the number?
- Where in your home do you see numbers?
- If I write FIFTY, can you also write it as a numeral?

Exit: Teacher writes a number (e.g.

Lesson 3: Make and Break 50

Goal: Numbers split into tens and ones. Different splits help with different problems.

Expectation: B1.2

Learning Goal: "I can compose and decompose any number to 50 using tens, ones, and partner pairs in different ways."

Materials: M3_base_ten_rods, M1_button_set

1. Minds On (12 mins): Otto's Marble Riddle

Otto has 32 marbles. He wants to put them in 2 jars. How many ways can he split them? Scoot brings out a rod stack: 'Make 50 your way — Scoot's curious!'

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Otto and 3 base-ten rods + 2 ones (= 32).

2. Action (25 mins): Make-the-Number Game

- Whole group: lead a structured decomposition of 32.
- Introduce the Make-the-Number game.
- Stretch round: each pair gets a target ≥ 30 and is challenged to find FOUR different decompositions.
- Mid-unit Numerals 0-50 Check-In: hand out the 4-prompt worksheet.
- Class debrief and chart-build.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Otto's Best Decomposition

Discuss:

- What was your favourite decomposition you found today?
- When is breaking a number into tens-and-ones useful?
- If I had 47 and wanted to add 3, how would I decompose?
- Can you tell me ONE thing in your everyday life that you could decompose? (e.g.

Exit: Each child whispers to a partner: 'I broke 35 into ____ + ____.' Partner says back what they would do differently.

Lesson 4: Compare and Order

Goal: Compare numbers by tens first, then ones. Order them on the number line.

Expectation: B1.3

Learning Goal: "I can compare two numbers up to 50 and order a small set from smallest to biggest."

Materials: M1_button_set, M2_estimation_jar, M4_number_line_floor

1. Minds On (10 mins): Whose Jar Has More?

Lila has a jar of 31 buttons. Otto has a jar of 38. Whose jar has more? Scoot lines up with Otto: 'Compare? I LOVE compare! Tens first!'

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up two jars side by side — one Lila's (31 buttons), one Otto's (38 buttons).

2. Action (22 mins): Number Line Ordering + Compare-the-Jar

- Whole-class activity on the floor mat.
- Introduce the 'tricky compare' rule: when two numbers have the SAME tens digit, look at the ones.
- Send pairs to Compare-the-Jar partner stations.
- Stretch round: at one station, 4 jars have CLOSE numbers (37, 38, 41, 42).
- Circulate to record formative evidence.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Number Line Walk-Out

Discuss:

- What's the rule for comparing two numbers?
- Are 38 and 41 close on the Number Line, or far apart?
- If I had 50 marbles and you had 35, who has more?
- Outside school, when do you compare numbers?

Exit: Each child holds up their sticky-note number from the floor walk.

Lesson 5: Fair Shares — Halves and Fourths

Goal: Sharing fairly between 2 friends gives halves; between 4 gives fourths. One half equals two fourths.

Expectation: B1.6, B1.7, B1.8

Learning Goal: "I can share a small collection fairly between 2 or 4 friends, draw the share, and tell that one half equals two fourths."

Materials: M5_fraction_pizza, M6_share_plates, M1_button_set

1. Minds On (12 mins): Otto's Pizza Party

Otto baked one pizza. 2 friends are coming over. How does he cut it? Scoot pops in with Lila + Otto: 'Fair shares are FRIENDLY shares!'

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Otto and a paper pizza (whole).

2. Action (25 mins): Fair-Share Rounds + Unit Fraction Sort

- WHOLE GROUP RECAP — 5 min — four 60-second mini-stations on the carpet, each mirroring one prior day:

- Station 1 (D1 — Count Big): Lila holds up a 10-rod, class counts on by 10s...

- Send children to small groups of 4.

- Round 2: 'Share 12 buttons fairly between 4 friends.' (3 each.) Then Round 3 (the leftover round): 'Share 13 buttons fairly between 2 friends.' (6 each + 1 leftover.) Round 4:...

- Pizza fraction reveal.

- Unit Fraction Sort.

- Closing summative artifact: hand out the Fair-Share + Fraction worksheet.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Closing Fraction Chat

Discuss:

- What's one thing in your house that gets shared fairly?
- If a pizza has 4 slices and you eat 2, what fraction did you eat?
- Which is more: $\frac{1}{2}$ of a pizza or $\frac{1}{4}$ of a pizza?
- Why does $\frac{1}{8}$ mean a SMALLER piece even though 8 is a bigger number than 4?

Exit: Each child whispers to a partner: ' $\frac{1}{2}$ of a pizza is the SAME as ____ /4.'

Partners answer: 'two-fourths!' Then the class chants: ' $\frac{1}{2} = \frac{2}{4}$!' Children pack up the manipulatives and line up at the...

Name: _____

Date: _____

Lila's Big Button Jar

Learning Goal: I can estimate how many in a collection up to 50, and count by 1s, 2s, 5s, and 10s to check.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Look at each button jar.
2. Three Number Lines.
3. How would YOU count 50 buttons fastest? Pick one strategy.

Real-Life Box

Show a real-life problem.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Number Friends Five Ways

Learning Goal: I can read and represent numbers to 50 in many ways and tell where I see numbers in everyday life.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Each row shows the same number in two ways.
2. Match each numeral to its word.
3. Pick a number between 10 and 50.

Part 3: Show It Five Ways

Pick a number between 10 and 50. Show it FIVE ways: numeral, word, ten-frames, base-ten rods, tally marks.

Date: _____

Make and Break 50

Learning Goal: I can compose and decompose any number to 50 using tens, ones, and partner pairs in different ways.

Instructions for the Student:

1. For each target number, write ONE tens-and-ones decomposition AND ONE different decomposition.
2. Find three different partner pairs for each target.
3. Pick a number between 25 and 50.

Part 1: Tens and Ones, Then a New Way

For each target number, write **ONE** tens-and-ones decomposition **AND ONE** different decomposition.

[illegible]

Date: _____

Learning Goal: I can compare two numbers up to 50 and order a small set from smallest to biggest.

1. Compare each pair.
2. Two ordering tasks.
3. Pick **THREE** numbers between 20 and 50.

[illegible]

Date: _____

Fair Shares and Fractions

Learning Goal: I can share a small collection fairly between 2 or 4 friends, draw the share, and tell that one half equals two fourths.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Share each collection fairly.
2. Two pizzas.
3. Four pizzas show different fractions of the SAME size pizza.

Part 3: Unit Fraction Order

Four pizzas show different fractions of the **SAME** size pizza.
Draw a line from the **BIGGEST** piece to the **SMALLEST** piece in

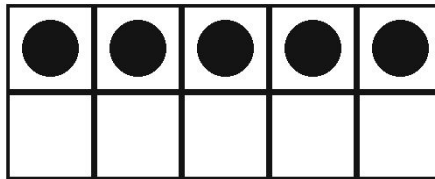
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Lila's Button Set

(M1_button_set)

Per-pair set of 50 small printed button cards in 5 colours (10 each).

Ten Frame



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 set per pair

Lessons: 1, 3, 4

Prep: ~30 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 set per pair (10 sets for a class of 20 = 20 pages).

2. Laminate every page before cutting.

3. Cut along cut-lines into 50 single button cards per set.

4. Store in labelled zip-top bags (50 buttons per bag).

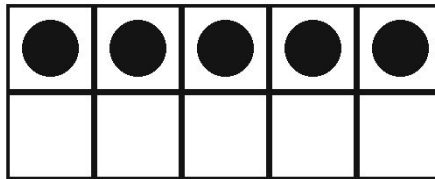
5. Optional: substitute real buttons from a sewing kit if you have a 500-button stash.

Estimation Button Jar

(M2_estimation_jar)

Clear jar with 35-50 buttons.

Ten Frame



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 jar template + 1 real jar

Lessons: 1, 4

Prep: ~8 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 jar label per classroom (1 page).

2. Laminate; tape to a real clear glass jar.

3. Fill the jar with 38 buttons on Day 1; swap to 50 on Day 4.

4. Place the jar at the carpet during Minds On.

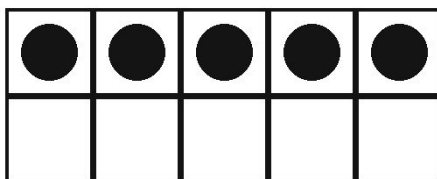
5. Optional: keep 2 jars (38 + 50) for compare-the-jar in Lesson 4.

Base-Ten Rods

(M3_base_ten_rods)

Per-child set: 5 ten-rods + 20 single ones.

Ten Frame



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: no

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 5 ten-rods + 20 ones per child

Lessons: 2, 3

Prep: ~12 min

TEACHER PREP

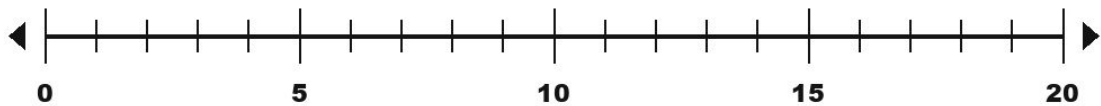
1. Prep this step carefully.
2. Print storage labels; tape to each child's bag.
3. Sort into per-child bags before Lesson 2.
4. Have bags ready at the start of Lessons 2 and 3.
5. Optional: use printed base-ten rod cards if you don't have physical rods.

Number Line Floor Mat

(M4_number_line_floor)

Long printable floor strip showing numbers 0 to 50.

Number Line 0-20



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 11

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 mat for the whole class

Lessons: 1, 4

Prep: ~25 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print all 11 pages on cardstock if available; otherwise paper + laminate.

2. Laminate each page before assembly.

3. Prep this step carefully.

4. Lay the strip on the carpet for Lessons 1 and 4; roll up after each lesson.

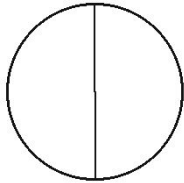
5. Optional: use a long roll of paper instead of tiled letter pages.

Fair-Share Pizza Cards

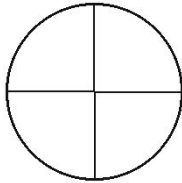
(M5_fraction_pizza)

Printable pizza cards showing whole, halved, fourthed, and other unit-fraction cuts.

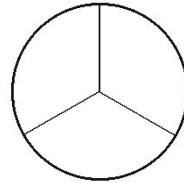
Pizza Fractions



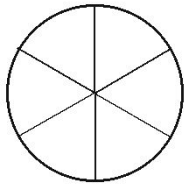
$\frac{1}{2}$



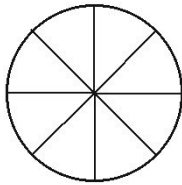
$\frac{1}{4}$



$\frac{1}{3}$



$\frac{1}{6}$



$\frac{1}{8}$

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 set per pair

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~15 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page per pair (10 pages for class of 20).

2. Laminate every page before cutting.

3. Cut along the borders to free the 6 pizzas per set.

4. Stack pizzas in a labelled folder; distribute at start of Lesson 5.

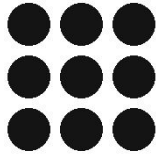
5. Prep this step carefully.

Sharing Paper Plates

(M6_share_plates)

Set of 4 paper plates per group of 4.

Array — 3 × 3



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 4 plates per group

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

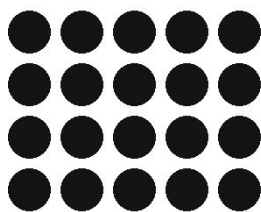
1. Print 1 page per group of 4 students (5 pages for class of 20).
2. Laminate before cutting.
3. Cut into 4 plates per page.
4. Distribute at the start of Lesson 5 small-group time.
5. Optional: use real paper plates from the supply closet.

Number-Word Match Cards

(M7_number_word_cards)

Per-pair set of 30 cards: 10 numerals + 10 number-words + 10 representations.

Array — 4 × 5



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 30 cards per pair

Lessons: 2

Prep: ~25 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 set of 2 pages per pair (10 sets for class of 20 = 20 pages).

2. Laminate before cutting.

3. Cut into 30 individual cards per set.

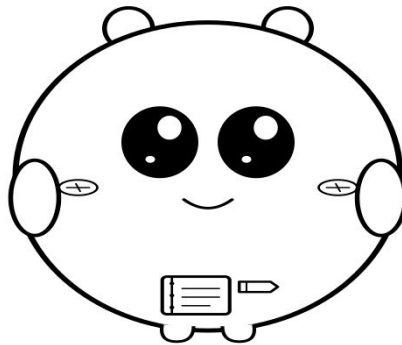
4. Store in labelled zip-top bags.

5. Optional: ELL/FSL classrooms — replace English number-words with bilingual cards.

Lila Lead Counter Puppet

(char_lila_puppet)

Printable Lila illustration mounted on a popsicle stick, used as the unit's lead character.



Lila

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet for the teacher

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page on cardstock if possible.

2. Cut around Lila's silhouette including the tab.

3. Glue or tape a popsicle stick behind the tab.

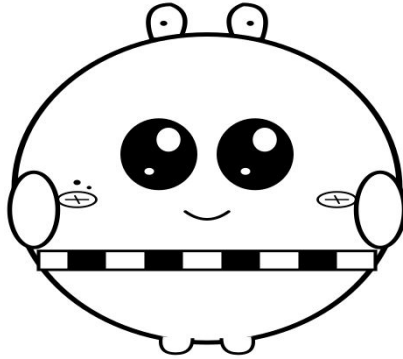
4. Optional: laminate before cutting.

5. Store flat in a folder.

Otto Partner Puppet

(char_otto_puppet)

Printable Otto illustration on a popsicle stick — Lila's pair partner.



Otto

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet for the teacher

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page on cardstock if possible.

2. Cut around Otto's silhouette including the tab.

3. Glue or tape a popsicle stick behind the tab.

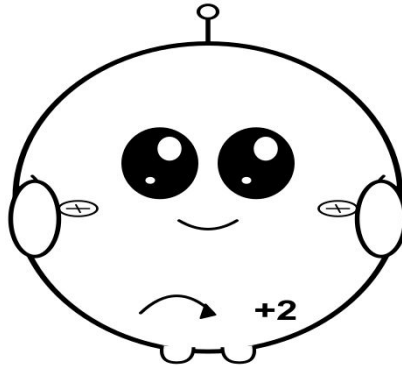
4. Optional: laminate before cutting.

5. Store next to the Lila puppet so they always travel together.

Scoot Counting Companion

(char_scoot_puppet)

Printable Scoot puppy mascot.



Scoot

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet for the teacher

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page on cardstock if possible.

2. Cut around Scoot's silhouette.

3. Glue or tape a popsicle stick behind the tab.

4. Optional: laminate before cutting.

5. Bring out for every lesson alongside Lila and Otto.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Summative Assessment Rubric

Expectation	Level 1 (Beginning)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 3 (Achieving)	Level 4 (Exceeding)
B1.1 read and represent whole numbers up to and including 50, and describe various ways they	Reads numerals to 20 reliably; struggles with words, ten-frames, base-ten rods, or tally marks at scale 50.	Reads numerals and words to 50; reads 1-2 of the alternative forms (ten-frames, rods, tally) with prompts.	Reads numbers to 50 in all 5 forms (numeral, word, ten-frames, base-ten rods, tally marks). Names a real-life	Reads all forms fluently to 50; spontaneously volunteers a 6th form or describes multiple real-life uses for
B1.2 compose and decompose whole numbers up to and including 50, using a variety of tools and	Decomposes in tens-and-ones with adult prompting; cannot find alternative decompositions.	Finds tens-and-ones decomposition independently; finds 1-2 alternatives with prompts.	Independently produces 3+ decompositions of a number to 50, including non-tens-and-ones partner pairs	Produces 5+ decompositions including creative pairs (16+16, 25+7); explains which decomposition is best for a
B1.3 compare and order whole numbers up to and including 50, in various contexts	Compares numbers to 20 with prompts; reverts to ones-first reasoning at scale 50.	Compares numbers to 50; uses tens-first reasoning with prompts.	Independently uses tens-first reasoning to compare numbers to 50; orders 4+ numbers smallest-to-biggest.	Uses tens-first reasoning fluently; articulates the rule unprompted; orders sets of 5+ numbers including
B1.4 estimate the number of objects in collections of up to 50, and verify their estimates by	Guesses without strategy; estimates often more than 15 off at scale 50.	Uses chunk strategy with prompting; estimates within 10 of actual sometimes.	Uses chunk-of-10 strategy independently; estimates within 5 of actual at scale 50.	Uses chunk strategy fluently; estimates within 3 of actual; explains the strategy unprompted.
B1.5 count to 50 by 1s, 2s, 5s, and 10s, using a variety of tools and strategies	Counts by 1s and 2s to 50 starting from 0; cannot skip-count by 5s or 10s.	Counts by 1s, 2s, 5s, 10s starting from 0; struggles with non-multiple starting points.	Counts by 1s, 2s, 5s, 10s to 50 starting from any number including non-multiples.	Skip-counts fluently; volunteers count-back from a number; uses skip-counting in real-life contexts.
B1.6 use drawings to represent and solve fair-share problems that involve 2 and 4 sharers	Distributes objects unevenly; cannot articulate fair share.	Shares evenly when totals divide cleanly; freezes on remainder cases.	Shares fairly between 2 and 4 sharers; articulates a remainder plan.	Shares fluently with leftover-of-2 cases; explains why dealing-strategy works for any total.
B1.7 recognize that one half and two fourths of the same whole are equal, in fair-sharing	Recognises halves; does not yet see $1/2 = 2/4$ even with overlay demo.	Recognises $1/2 = 2/4$ after the half-on-fourths overlay demo.	Recognises $1/2 = 2/4$ unprompted; can also see $2/2 = 4/4 = 1$ whole.	Generalises to other equivalences (e.g. $1/3 = 2/6$); volunteers connections to compose/decompose.
B1.8 use drawings to compare and order unit fractions representing the individual portions	Says bigger denominator = bigger piece (whole-number rule transferred). Reverses the comparison.	Recognises that more sharers = smaller pieces with overlay demo; flips back to bigger-bottom-bigger-piece	Orders unit fractions $1/2$ to $1/8$ from biggest to smallest pieces correctly; articulates the	Generalises to $1/100$ (tiny piece); volunteers connections to fair-sharing scenarios with many sharers.

Junior Number Friend Certificate

This certificate is proudly presented to:

For successfully completing the 5-Day Number Friends unit and demonstrating the skills of a Junior Number Friend. Lila and Otto, and Scoot the puppy, congratulate the student and welcome them to the next adventure in numbers.

By completing this unit, this student has demonstrated:

- Estimating a small collection up to 50 using the chunk-of-10 strategy
- Counting to 50 by 1s, 2s, 5s, and 10s starting from any number
- Reading and representing numbers to 50 in five different forms
- Composing and decomposing numbers to 50 in multiple ways
- Comparing and ordering numbers to 50 using tens-first reasoning

Marketplace Listing

A 5-day Ontario Grade-1 unit on Numbers (B1.1-B1.8), framed around Lila the Button Collector, Otto the Marble Counter, and Scoot the puppy mascot.

Price: \$11.99 CAD

Pages: ~42

Classroom time: 240 min

Teacher prep: ~120 min

Top tags: grade-1, math, ontario-curriculum, numbers, estimation, compose-decompose, compare-order, fair-sharing

What's included:

- 5 fully-scripted lesson plans with 50-minute durations and 235 minutes of total teaching time
- 5 student worksheets aligned to each lesson with name/date fields and child-voice learning goals
- 1 mid-unit formative assessment (Numerals 0-50 Check-In) administered between Lessons 3 and 4
- 10 printable teacher manipulatives: button card set, estimation jar template, base-ten rod label, Number Line floor mat (11 letter pages), pizza fraction...
- 1 end-of-unit reflection sheet with 5 self-assessment prompts
- 4 class observation trackers: 1 diagnostic (Lesson 1) + 3 formative (Lessons 2, 3, 4)
- 1 eight-row summative rubric covering B1.1-B1.8 across 4 levels
- 1 summative-administration guide tying the rubric to Lesson 5 worksheet
- Junior Number Friend certificate (one per child) for the closing ceremony
- Detailed expanded walkthroughs for every lesson including the rod-moving demo for the single-strategy decomposition trap and the pizza-overlay demo for the...
- Differentiation tracks built into every lesson: emerging learners, extending learners, ELL/IEP, and movement-first learners